

ISADORROSPAINEDIT

Travel Radio Australia, Travel Radio World. We are at the fantastic ILTM, the International Luxury Travel Market in Cannes in France, and I have from Spain, from the Tourist Board of Spain, Isidoro Manzares Nieto. Isidoro, welcome to the program.

Thank you very much for hosting me. It's a pleasure. Tourism in Spain is so huge.

You're part of the group that organizes all the tourism for the incoming people for Spain. And tell us, first of all, ILTM, it's such an iconic venue here, and a great conference. Tell us about your experience here at ILTM, first of all.

Well, for us, the ILTM is like a very important fair. It's one of those fairs that we always organize, and we always want to come here. Not only because we are seeing that it experiences like a much better demand now, also because it's addressed to a very segmented public.

This is like luxury, premium tourism that we are very concerned to promote in Spain, and I think it also creates additional high value for our market. So definitely, this is one of the fairs where we want to and we need to be. Now, Spain has such a huge range of things on offer for international tourists coming from Australia, the United States, the UK, anywhere in the world, and France especially as well.

Tell us about some of the things that are new, things that people can see and do that really stand out. I'm sure that there's new things happening all the time. Yes, exactly.

Spain is very well known for international cities such as Barcelona, Madrid, our fabulous coast. Actually, right now, we are trying to convey to the public that we are much more than that. Actually, we are sitting here right now next to the panels of our new campaign, which is like, think you know Spain, think again.

Because in this campaign, we are trying to show the rest of Spain. Spain is a big country. There are a lot of regions that really hide jewels for tourism.

All the interior lands, the north of Spain, which is seeing a huge development right now in Spain. All that part that is not quite famous among the international tourists, it's being now discovered. You need to rediscover Spain with that because, as I said, there is a lot of offer, cultural offer, fantastic historical villages, nature.

We want to invite the international visitors to know much more, to go to those hidden jewels that are waiting for you there. Well, I've been to a number of places in Spain. I've been to Barcelona and I've been to Alicante, which is in the mountains.

It's so beautiful up there, isn't it? Yes, it is. Obviously, it's also like Alicante in the region of Valencia. It's also like a very well-known city, one of the international cities historically, and they

receive like a huge number of tourists.

The good thing is that it's not only a beautiful coast side, but as well, you have like different villages around Alicante, for example, Elche, if you don't know it, it's one city with the largest palm field in Europe. So you can just enter there, feel like in the jungle surrounded by palms, which is like quite a unique view, plus all different historical and heritage sites that are around and in this city in particular. And of course, the capital cities, Barcelona.

Tell us about some of those for people who've never been to Spain. What should they be looking out for? Well, Barcelona is definitely one of the most vibrant cities that you can find. It's a very good moment to go to Barcelona, any like big city in Spain.

You can experience how the Spanish culture works, how Spanish people live, which is a quite interesting way of traveling. Obviously, now in Barcelona, it's very interesting as well because you can, this year, well, in 2026, you will be able to see finally the Sagrada Familia, the great church in Barcelona, finally finished because it's been built for lots of years still now and it's going to be finally ended. This is like a great Gaudí project.

But I invite the visitors not only to stay in Barcelona, but could go to surroundings because you can also see another like, another buildings of Gaudí, this modernism culture and, well, the wine fields and any other, actually, any other offer you want to experience, you can find. Yeah, so last time I was there in the early 2000s, it was still under construction, the Gaudí church and it was so, people wondered when is this going to be finished. Well, that is an amazing thing.

It's actually going to be finished in 2026 and I can imagine the ceremonies of the opening are going to be like an Olympic event or something, right? Well, actually, the basilica is working. It's like, it's open and it's all the time being open. Let's wait for the final touch.

Let's wait for the final stone to be placed. Actually, I read in the last news that they're completing one of the main towers, which makes this basilica the tallest basilica, the tallest church in the whole Europe. We need to see it finished because it's been a lot of years.

We are looking forward for it. It's like more than 100 years as Gaudí's times, since modernism. So we're already like closer to our century, but still it's quite a long way.

I'm speaking with Isidoro Manzares. Just give us your proper pronunciation of your name. It's Manzares.

Oh, Manzares. Okay. Nieto.

He's with Tourism Spain. It's such a beautiful place to visit if you are coming from the United States. Like I was talking earlier, a lot of our Australian listeners come for a month or two and they're looking for things to do.

Spain is such a great destination, especially if you're in Amsterdam going down to the Rhine on the boat and you're wondering what to do after that. Spain is just a hop, just so close. Yes, definitely.

Spain is like a good option to go when you are doing this European tour because we are part of the history. We have played an important role in the history of Europe. I would say that Europe is incomplete if you don't visit Spain.

You just need to see that our kings have been part of this building of the European feeling. We have been always like very linked to all our neighbors. You definitely need to visit it.

It's easy to do it because it's also like an important hub for America and also for the East. Spain as its location is a bit peripheral in Europe, but it's very centric in the world. At the end, we are like a halfway between Africa, America and Asia.

If you don't come to this melting pot, it will be like a missed opportunity. We can't go without mentioning the fabulous islands, the Spanish islands. They're so famous, Ibiza and all the places like that.

Yes, exactly. Well, we have two groups of islands in Spain, Balearic Islands. They were well known for Mallorca, Ibiza and also the Canary Islands.

Two main islands are Gran Canaria and Tenerife. These islands offer very different approaches. Even every island is different from the other islands.

There are some where you can find just a desert, other ones with several vegetation. Obviously, their characters are very different. Everyone knows that Ibiza is very vibrant.

Its heritage is like a world heritage city as well. We have a family offer, we have a premium offer and everything is ready for great holidays there. Well, speaking of Ibiza, it's becoming now much more of a nature thing because it had a reputation for many, many years of being just a party place, but the island itself is so beautiful in nature and a lot of people, even the young people, are saying we're moving away from the party 24 hours a day type system into just discovering the nature of Ibiza as well.

Yes, it's very green. It's a very, very green island. I need to say that also it's an island that lives two different lives.

It's not the same this island in summer where there is like a higher amount of flux of tourism and this island in winter, which is March, summer. It's different. It's a different way to enjoy the island.

I need to highlight obviously this historical center that the island has because it's like it's something so beautiful that it's much more stunning than some of the parties that can go on there. They can visit our website tourspain.info. It's available in the different languages, obviously

English, French and any other language of all the markets that we work with. We also have different social networks.

You can follow us on Instagram or X networks from your local market. That is, you can find it in English, you can find it in French. We try to get to everyone to have a close communication with the tourists and invite them to see and discover our country.

And can you say for our international audience something in Spanish, our international audience, to welcome them to the wonderful country of Spain? So Doris, it's been a pleasure. Thank you for being part of the program. Thank you very much.

It's been a pleasure too.